Professor Pramod Kumar, who heads the placement cell, expects even better numbers this year as more opportunities are coming up in the post-pandemic industry. And IIMC has taken all possible steps to prepare students for new-age jobs. For instance, as most students in recent years were getting absorbed by digital platforms, it introduced a new course in digital journalism in three of its centres. Every centre admits 20 students each in this course.

That's not all. Now on the path to becoming a deemed university, the institute is all set to launch five new courses, as mandated by the University Grants Commission (UGC). It has been reviewing the syllabi of all courses. Soon, as per the National Education Policy, it will introduce the academic credit system. Three new publications have been started, while the existing ones have been relaunched with improved content and design.

In fact, constant innovation to keep pace with changes in the industry has been one of the hallmarks of IIMC, Delhi. The pocket-sized campus, nestled on one side of the JNU greens, is equipped with a state-of-the-art library, two auditoriums, TV and community radio studios, hostel facilities and multiple laboratories. Each department has been assigned a computer lab. A new lab has been set up to train students in existing and emerging editing software for print, audio, TV and web. After the pandemic, all classrooms were converted into digital ones—at a cost of Rs 75 lakh—so that teaching can happen in physical, virtual or hybrid mode, depending on the situation. Students from other centres can also access Delhi lectures.

Sixteen new faculty members have joined in the past two years, taking the total teaching strength in the Delhi campus to 27 for the 300-plus students enrolled across courses. No faculty position is vacant now. "We asked the government to provide for 40 new faculty posts, considering that the number of centres has grown from just two to six. The ministry instantly sanctioned 20 and said that 20 more will be sanctioned once 75 per cent of the first 20 posts are filled," says Prof. Sanjay Dwivedi, the director general of IIMC.

While teachers do play an important role in making IIMC the best in the business, Prof. Dwivedi believes geographical location is an added advantage to the Delhi centre. "It's in the national capital, which is considered the mecca of journalism. It's easy for IIMC, Delhi, to get the best resources

TOP 10 COLLEGES WITH LOWEST FEES

RANK	COLLEGE	CITY	COURSE FEE (ENTIRE DURATION)
1	DEPARTMENT OF MASS COMMUNICATION, ALIGARH MUSLIM UNIVERSITY	Aligarh	₹11,830
2	PAZHASSIRAJA COLLEGE PULPALLY	Wayanad	₹13,460
3	S.S. JAIN SUBODH P.G. COLLEGE, (AUTONOMOUS)	Jaipur	₹30,000
4	MAKHANLAL CHATURVEDI NATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF JOURNALISM AND COMMUNICATION	Bhopal	₹44,610
5	BBK DAV COLLEGE FOR WOMEN	Amritsar	₹44,730
6	DEPARTMENT OF JOURNALISM & MASS COMMUNICATION, PSG COLLEGE OF ARTS & SCIENCE	Coimbatore	₹45,000
7	SARDAR PATEL MAHAVIDYALAYA	Chandrapur	₹45,678
8	HANS RAJ MAHILA MAHA VIDYALAYA	Jalandhar	₹54,100
9	KISHINCHAND CHELLARAM COLLEGE	Mumbai	₹58,500
10	ST. JOSEPH'S COLLEGE (AUTONOMOUS) IRINJALAKUDA	Thrissur	₹60,000

*Course fee = Tuition fee + other fees

NEW INITIATIVES

- New course in digital journalism started in three IIMC centres, including Delhi
- On the path to becoming a deemed university, IIMC is set to launch five new courses, as mandated by UGC
- All classrooms in the Delhi centre have been digitalised
- New laboratory set up to train students in existing and emerging editing softwares
- Three new publications started, old ones redesigned and relaunched